



OTC Exception Portfolio Canvas

A practical worksheet for converting recurring friction into an evidence-based process-product decision.

1. TRACE THE CUSTOMER COMMITMENT

Commitment	Validation	Availability	Fulfillment	Delivery	Invoice	Payment	Learning
Selected journey / segment			Accountable workflow owner				
Customer promise affected							
Exception statement							
Where first detected			Where likely created				

2. CLASSIFY THE FRICTION

Class	Evidence	Legitimate variation?	Recurrence / aging
Data integrity			
Process / handoff			
Policy / terms			
Integration / system			
Authority / escalation			
Adoption / behavior			

3. QUANTIFY THE BURDEN

Customer Delay, disruption, confidence, recovery. Baseline: _____	Flow Cycle time, touches, aging, rework. Baseline: _____	Control Evidence, consistency, auditability. Baseline: _____	Economics Cost-to-serve, credits, cash, expedite. Baseline: _____
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Choose and govern the intervention

4. SELECT THE SMALLEST USEFUL INTERVENTION

Intervention	Use when	Selected rationale
Eliminate	The work is avoidable and the root condition can be removed.	
Standardize	Variation is unnecessary and a clear rule protects value or control.	
Redesign	The workflow or handoff creates the recurrence.	
Assist	Context or ambiguity requires human judgment with better support.	
Automate	Rules, data, ownership, controls, and exception paths are stable.	
Escalate	The decision is consequential, rare, or outside delegated authority.	

5. DEFINE AUTHORITY AND EVIDENCE

Human decision retained		Escalation boundary	
Technical owner		Control / quality owner	
Adoption owner		Value owner	
Proof metric and baseline			
Failure / stop condition			

6. MAKE THE PORTFOLIO DECISION

Scale Value, behavior, controls, ownership, and transfer conditions hold.	Redesign / partner Problem remains material, but intervention or ownership needs change.	Hold / stop Evidence does not justify more burden, risk, or investment.
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REUSE TEST

What transfers unchanged? What requires local configuration? What must remain local judgment? Which data, integration, control, and ownership conditions are required?

Portfolio rule: Do not scale a solution merely because the technology is reusable. Scale only when the decision logic, operating conditions, ownership, and retained value are reusable.